
EMPOWER
Tools for those who are equipped and ready to go and evangelize to the world.
navigators™

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Read through each of the following five traits, making observations about how you can live these out in your context and community.

5 Marks of a **DISCIPLEMAKER**

1 JESUS

A passion to know, love and become like Christ

Philippians 3:8-10

Followers of Christ with a passion to know and love Jesus. As disciplemakers and laborers in the harvest, they are purposeful to nurture and deepen their intimacy with Him. Life and ministry overflows from time alone with Jesus. The focus is developing personal intimacy with Jesus. It's more than just knowing about God. It's knowing Him and walking deeply with Him.

2 THE WORD

Knows and lives from the Scriptures

2 Timothy 3:16-17

A disciplemaker is one who can handle accurately the Word of God. They know how to read it, study it, talk about it and pass it on to others. A disciplemaker understands the truth and sufficiency of the Word for the whole of life.

3 COMMUNITY

Pursuing Biblical community

Hebrews 10:24-25

The Lord designed us to walk with Him in community with others. A disciplemaker will be intentional to seek, pursue and create a local community of believers to spur each other toward love and good deeds. Biblical community includes family as well as extended communities of followers of Christ. Biblical community also draws those without Christ to the Lord (John 13:33-34).

4 THE LOST

Lives among those who do not know or follow Christ

I Thessalonians 2:8

A disciplemaker will be among those who are without Christ. They will be purposeful to love, serve and help them know and understand the Gospel. They are marked by strong commitment to the Great Commission and a strong compassion for the brokenness of those without Christ. Disciplemakers proclaim and affirm the Gospel with both their words and their lives.

5 SPIRITUAL GENERATIONS

Advancing the Gospel through spiritual generations

2 Timothy 2:2

A disciplemaker is personally involved with helping others move closer to Christ as Savior and Lord. Disciplemakers meet one on one to help non-believers understand who Christ claims to be, and to establish young believers in their faith. A disciplemaker may lead groups of others in studying and applying the Word. Anything that helps others move closer to Christ is discipleship. A disciplemaker helps others catch a vision for investing their lives in others so that others will disciple more to do the same... towards spiritual generations.

THIS TOOL IS MEANT TO BE SHARED. To download a copy visit navlink.org/disciplemaker

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MANY ASPIRE, FEW ATTAIN

"Enter through the narrow gate. For wide is the gate and broad is the road that leads to destruction, and many enter through it. But small is the gate and narrow the road that leads to life, and only a few find it."
Matthew 7:13-14

Jesus invites all to lay down their lives, pick up their cross, and follow Him. Sadly, experience shows that while His invitation is broad, only a few finish well.

Paul had the end in mind when he wrote in 2 Timothy 4:7-8 -- *I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith. Now there is in store for me the crown of righteousness, which the Lord, the righteous Judge, will award to me on that day—and not only to me, but also to all who have longed for his appearing.*

David sought this principle by aiming to keep the main thing the main thing, as reflected in Psalm 27:4 -- *One thing I ask from the Lord, this only do I seek: that I may dwell in the house of the Lord all the days of my life, to gaze on the beauty of the Lord and to seek him in his temple.*

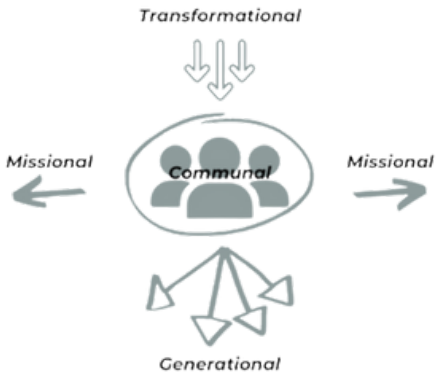
Ezra similarly grasped this principle in Ezra 7:10 -- *For Ezra had set his heart to study the law of The Lord, and to do it and to teach his statues and rules in Israel*. He sought to know God first for himself, and only then to teach it to others.

In 1975, Walt Henrichsen wrote a timeless article called "Many Aspire, Few Attain." Spend time reading through the article and consider the questions below:

Discussion Questions

- What impacted you most from the article?
- Is there one or two of the points that you find yourself most susceptible to? What will you do about that?
- Who will you invite to be in the inside of your life and journey with you?
- What is one application you will make as a result of reading this article?

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DISCIPLEMAKING COMMUNITIES

Western cultures can often view the Bible through an individualistic lens, whereas other cultures gravitate towards a communal lens. In English, there is no good word that expresses the plural form of "you." Yet, "all of you" is often a more accurate reading of many of Paul's instructions to the early churches in the Epistles.

READ

Spend time reading 1 Thessalonians 1:2-10 in the "you'all" version. As you read, consider the question: What separates a group of friends from an intentional, disciplemaking community?

"2We thank God always for all y'all, mentioning y'all in our prayers, 3constantly remembering before our God and Father y'all's work of faith, labor of love, and perseverance of hope in our Lord Jesus Christ. 4We know, siblings beloved by God, that y'all are chosen, 5and that our gospel came to y'all not in word only, but also in power, and in the Holy Spirit, and with deep conviction. Y'all saw how we lived among y'all for your* sake. 6Y'all became imitators of us and of the Lord, having received the word with the joy of the Holy Spirit despite deep oppression.

7As a result y'all became an example to all the believers in Macedonia and in Achaia. 8For the word of the Lord has reverberated out from y'all, not only in Macedonia and Achaia, but y'all's faith in God has spread everywhere. We don't even need to say anything, 9for the people themselves are reporting what kind of reception we had with y'all, and how y'all turned to God from idols to serve a living and true God, 10and to wait for His Son from heaven, whom he raised from the dead: Jesus, who delivers us from the wrath to come."

OBSERVE

Disciplemaking Communities (DMCs) can manifest themselves in a variety of contexts, but all share four primary categories (below). Consider the questions below as you think back through 1 Thess 1:2-10.

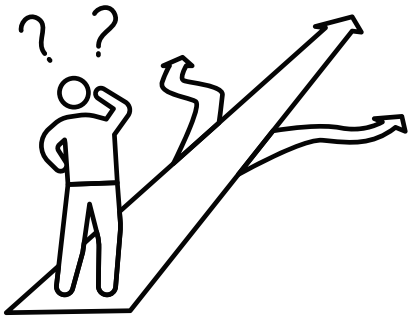
- Communal: Are they friends? How are the 'One Another's' of Scripture being lived out?
- Transformational: Is the Gospel transforming lives of individuals? Are there ways community could help spur this transformation on?
- Missional: Are friends being reached with the Gospel? Do individuals in the DMC know where their areas of influence exist? Are there shared areas of influence among those in the DMC that can be reached together?
- Generational: Is there the intention of reaching the next generation? How is the next generation included in this DMC? How will this DMC be used to launch teams to help future generations?

PERSONALIZE & APPLY

Are there communities you are currently a part of (insider) that could become Disciplemaking Communities? What are some specific next steps you could take?

Are there situations where you function as either someone who comes alongside another to help them minister, or an area in your life where you are directly ministering among others? How might these areas benefit from what you've observed about DMCs? What is one step you could take to help this area function as an intentional disciplemaking community?

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DECISION-MAKING
DISCERNING GOD'S WILL AND CALLING

SURRENDER TO DOING GOD's WILL - the key to any decision

Because God is God, He will have no trouble in communicating to us what He wants us to do. Our problem is doing God's will, not knowing God's will! We must be willing to do whatever He desires for us, before He will let us know His plan for us. This can be frightening, but if we really know God and His love, we will also trust Him that He will only give us good things.
John 7:17; Romans 12:1-2; Jeremiah 29:11; Matthew 7:9-11

5 MEANS TO DISCERNING GOD'S WILL

1. The Word of God - Psalm 119:105; Proverbs 6:22-23
Obviously, if something is contrary to a direct teaching in Scripture, it is not the will of God [i.e. marrying a non-Christian (2 Corinthians 6:14)]. But God can also speak to us concerning our specific situations from the bible. You will know in your heart that this is God's promise to you concerning your decision.

2. Personal Peace When We Pray - Philippians 4:6-7; Psalm143:8,10; Isaiah 30:21
Though you may not have all the answers yet, you will have a deep peace of heart, a rest in your heart, knowing that this is from God. The Holy Spirit will confirm in your heart that this is the way, even if it involves hardship or sadness.

3. Counsel From Mature Believers - Proverbs 15:22; 13:20; 19:20
Objective counsel from mature believers will be used to give perspective and direction. It is hard to get counsel from someone who does not have hidden motives. Finding the right counselors who know us, want our best and God's best is a challenge, but God will send them along. Your parents are some of the best counselors you will find. Notice that it is the abundance of counselors that gives wisdom. Most people will just tell you what you want to hear, especially your friends, because they don't want to jeopardize the friendship.

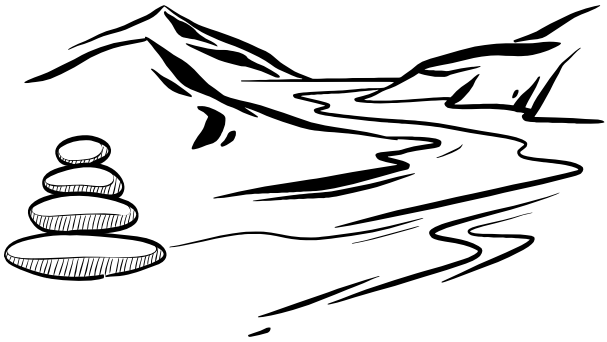
4. Wise Thinking - 1 Peter 1:13; Proverbs 3:5-6
God gave you a lot of leading when He gave you a brain. Use a plus/minus system to think through the good and bad points of any decision. The Scriptures teach us not to lean on our own understanding, but they don't say to not use our own understanding! Just don't depend on it only.

5. Providential Circumstances - Revelation 3:7-8; Acts 16:6-9
God will open doors to guide us. He will close doors to lead us to other open doors. He will provide opportunities.

**The more of the five things that we see agreeing, pointing in the same direction, the more certain we can be that this is God's will. If one or two agree, but the others don't, we have two possibilities. It may be God's will, but the wrong timing. Or, it may not be God's will. In either case, it's best to wait; time will clarify. Immaturity will press ahead when things are not clear and pay a big price! (Proverbs 19:2)

GOD IS SOVEREIGN

Remember, the foundation is surrendering to doing God's will. We can deceive ourselves. We can find verses to justify just about anything. We can "have peace" about a lot of things. Satan can open doors for us also. However, also remember this: God being God, He will not allow circumstances, governments, organizations, or anyone with authority over us to hinder His plan for us. In fact, He uses them to direct us to His plan for us (see Joseph in Genesis 50:20).



MEMORIAL STONES

Throughout scripture God calls His people to create memorial stones or *"ebenezers"* to remind themselves of His character and deeds, so that they can continue to persevere in loving and following Him. We also want to be people of remembrance and perseverance. Read the following verses and make observations:

Deuteronomy 6:1-12 **[The Importance of Remembering]**

- Why is it important to remember the Lord and His deeds?
- How are people called to remember?

Joshua 4:1-9, 19-24 **[An Example of a Memorial Stone]**

- Why was the memorial significant? What did it teach them about God?

Judges 2:10-13 **[Warning Against Forgetting]**

- What was the result of Israel forgetting the Lord?

How has God been revealing Himself and developing you?

Work through the following steps to help identify some of your own memorial stones and life lessons.

Step 1 - Identifying Your Memorial Stones

Identify both positive and negative memorial stones—people, circumstances, and events that God has used to shape your life. Consider, but do not limit yourself to, some of the following categories:

Crisis/Losses/Pain	Parents, significant relatives
Defeats/Failure	Conflicts
Victories	Successes/Blessings
Adverse circumstances	Meaningful scripture, promises
Friends, mentors	Major decisions

Be sure to spend time in prayer. Ask God to reveal to you elements of your life that could establish patterns as to how He has developed you and/or taught you about Himself.

Step 2 - Reflecting on Life Lessons

Pray and ask God for insight into what He might have been saying to you or teaching you. Feel the freedom to work on this over the course of a set period of time, not just in one sitting.

1. Referring to your timeline, identify 3-5 key memorial stones. Focus on a person, event, or circumstance, not a period of time.
2. Reflect on how God used the experience and how you experienced Him. List what you learned in the Life Lessons column.
3. Identify the biblical concept in what He was teaching you. What scriptures are tied to this concept? List the Biblical concept and scripture in their respective columns.

Step 3 - Crystallizing Life Lessons

1. Review the lessons and phrase them to make them easy to remember - alliteration, rhyme, short phrase, etc.
2. Consider if there are Themes - the Lord may reveal some themes in how you have experienced Him and His work in your life. As you become aware of them, add these to your worksheet.
3. Share your life lessons with others to get their feedback.
4. Periodically come back to your timeline and see if God will grant you insight into life lessons from other memorial stones.

MEMORIAL STONES

Step 1: Personal Memorial Stones (Example)

Timeframe	Favorable people, events, etc	Difficult people, events, etc
Freshmen year	Bible study; friendship with *S	Break-up; Halloween partying
Sophomore year	SF trip with *R; study abroad	Roommate conflict; SHAW study
Junior year	sister reading Bible; missions trip	Grandma's death; mental health issues
Senior year	Sister dinners; discipling *L	Relationship with *E; discerning future

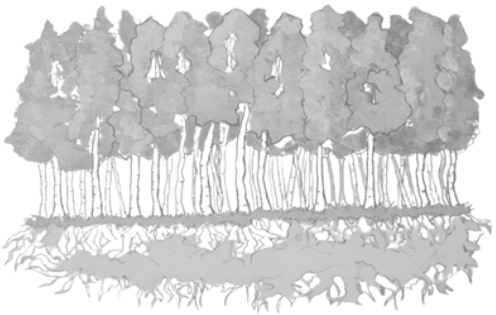
Step 2-3: Life Lessons Exercise (Example)

Memorial Stones	Biblical Concept	Life Lesson	Biblical Passage
1| Deciding to do freshmen Bible study	Guidance	You Jesus, have good things planned for me	Ephesians 2:10; Isaiah 30:21
2| Break-up freshmen year	Chosen by You	Necessary to experience better things you had for me	Ephesians 1:4-5
3| Teaching sister how to read the Bible	You pursue people	You invite me to pray for and invest in others	1 Thess 2:8
Theme - God, you are faithful to protect and choose me.			

Reflection & Application

- How does this impact your relationship Jesus? Your ministry to others?
- How will these lessons help you persevere in this next season of life?
- How could you integrate or share these life lessons with others in your life and ministry?

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PERSERVERING IN FELLOWSHIP

And let us consider how we may spur one another on toward love and good deeds, not giving up meeting together, as some are in the habit of doing, but encouraging one another—and all the more as you see the Day approaching.
Hebrews 10:24-25

Aspen trees are unique in that they have roots that are connected together to unite the trees into one organism. So it is meant to be in the body of Christ -- we are designed to be interconnected to others in the body, united under the headship of Christ. As we journey through life, our primary source of fellowship may shift. In life, we may find belonging in places like friends, our church body, family, and/or marriage. In each of us is the danger towards extremes, either of isolation or co-dependence. Which extreme do you find it easiest to gravitate towards and why?

Spend time considering the verses below that describe how we are to relate to "one another."

- John 13:34-35
- Romans 12:10
- Romans 15:7
- 1 Peter 4:9
- Romans 12:16
- Ephesians 4:32
- Ephesians 4:2-3

We all desire to be fully known and fully loved. To be loved but not known is comforting, but superficial. To be known and not loved is our greatest fear. Consider the quote below by pastor Tim Keller. What stands out to you?

...to be fully known and truly loved is, well, a lot like being loved by God. It is what we need more than anything. It liberates us from pretense, humbles us out of our self-righteousness, and fortifies us for any difficulty life can throw at us

Consider the principles below and what the Bible teaches us about community. What principle impacts you the most?

1. Mankind was not meant to be alone (Gen 2:18)
2. Mankind has always feared isolation (Gen 4:13)
3. Mankind has always pursued community (Gen 11:2)
4. Mankind has always been tempted to replace God with community (Gen 11:4)

Consider the four practical principles below. What application would you like to make moving forward in life as you persevere in fellowship with others?

- Intentionality – quality is not dictated by frequency.
- Consistency – patience & repetition wins hearts.
- Vulnerability – model the depth of relationship you want.
- Consolidating – make the most of existing circumstances around you.

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Alongsiders:
LIFE-TO-LIFE DISCIPLESHIP

Alongsiders are committed to making disciples one conversation and one relationship at a time.

JESUS WAS AN ALONGSIDER

Jesus intentionally ministered Life-to-Life™ with a select few. When the Lord invited His disciples to "be with him" (Mark 3:14), it meant joining the Lord in His life. Together, they went to social events and on walking expeditions. They enjoyed faith conversations, and shared in the joys and sorrows of ministry.

PAUL AS AN ALONGSIDER

The apostle Paul practiced a relational approach to ministry. Even though he often launched a church and moved on, he still maintained a relational ministry. From his example in the Thessalonian church, what can you observe about his relational approach?

Read these sections of 1 Thessalonians:

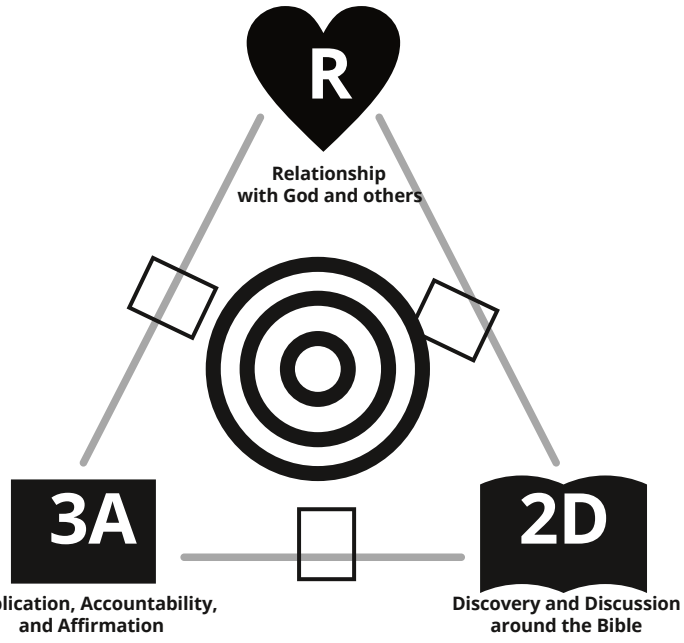
- 1 Thessalonians 2:7
- 1 Thessalonians 2:8
- 1 Thessalonians 2:11-12

- What do you think it meant for Paul to be like a mother or a father to this new group of believers?
- Describe Paul's intentionality in growing the faith of these new believers.

YOU AS AN ALONGSIDER

Who has God placed you alongside in your work, home, or play aspects of life? Is there someone in your spheres of relationship that you can come alongside and disciple?

An overview of how an alongsider structures discipleship.



BULL'S-EYE: The New Testament's portrait of a disciple becomes the target you aim for in making disciples.

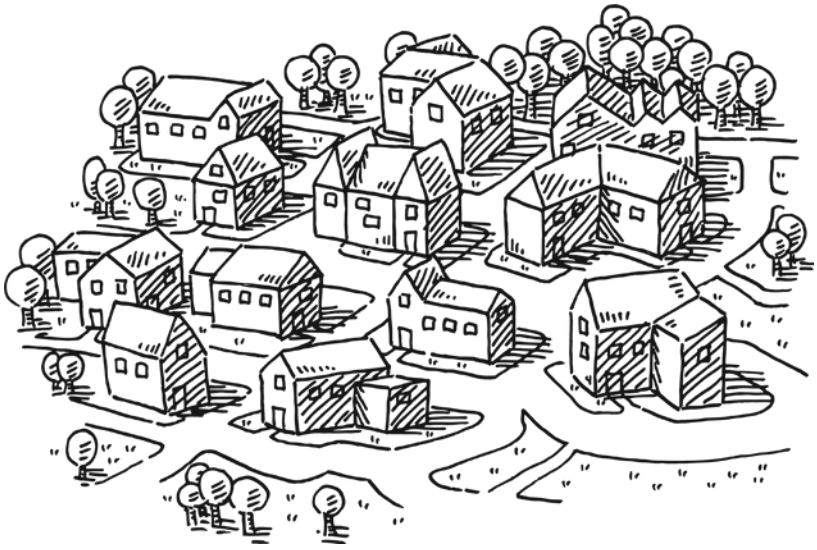
R: The R stands for relationships. A relationship with God and a relationship with those whom we disciple provide the appropriate context for the disciplemaking process.

2D: There is always an open Bible between an alongsider and the person he or she is discipling. Around this open Bible, discovery and discussion (2D) take place.

3A: Discipleship includes application, accountability, and affirmation. Alongsiders are on an application journey. Accountable relationships encourage follow-through. Affirmation encourages people to keep going.

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30 DAYS OF PRAYING THROUGH YOUR NEIGHBORHOOD

By: Kirk Lauckner (Navigators 20's, Seattle)

There is something deep and transformational that happens when we walk the streets of our commu- nity while conversing with God.

This is an invitation to au- dacity - to believe that the gospel is transformative today and that God's Spirit is at work in the unique- ness of our own individual- ity and that of our neigh- borhoods.

Throughout the next 30 days, be intentional. Take time to WALK, PRAY, PAY ATTENTION, and LISTEN.

Day One: *Lord, would you please deepen my love for my neighborhood, this place I call home.* "The Word became flesh and moved into the neighbor- hood." (John 1:14, The Message)

Day Two: Do I know the names of my neighbors? *Lord, help me to learn the names of those living by me.*

Day Three: *Lord, thank You for the gift of a new day! May You surprise me as I walk these streets and enjoy this time with You. May a "divine appointment" happen today!*

Day Four: When was the last time I was invited to my neighbors' home? When was the last time I had a neighbor over for dinner? *Lord, would You give me the time and capacity to prac- tice hospitality? Is there someone we could invite for dinner within the next month?*

Day Five: *Lord, help me be faithfully present in my neighborhood. May I inten- tionally say "yes" and "no" to the right things so I have more time for my neigh- bors.*

Day Six: What promises am I praying over my neighbor- hood? While I am walking today bring to mind specif- ic scripture that speaks to loving people, the neighborhood, and the expansion of the gospel.

Day Seven: Are there other Christ-followers in my neighborhood? Who else can join us? *Lord, would you please help me identify "people of peace" or people who care deeply about my neighborhood.*

Day Eight: *Lord, would You please deepen my love for my neighborhood, this "place" I call home.* "The Word became flesh and moved into the neighbor- hood." (John 1:14, The Message)

Day Nine: *Lord, help me to see my neighborhood with Your eyes. May my heart break for those things that break Your heart.*

Day Ten: Today while walking I will bring a bag and pick up trash along the way. *Lord, thank you for Your creation; help me to steward and care for the beauty of the earth You have made.*

Day Eleven: Today I will give thanks! As I walk I will focus on the blessings that God has given me. Much like a riv- er that is overflowing, I will al- low "thanks" to well up inside my heart. *Lord, thank You for my neighborhood, my home, food, and the daily comforts that I so often take for grant- ed. Thank You!* "So then, just as you received Christ Jesus as Lord, continue to live in Him, rooted and built up in Him, strengthened in the faith as you were taught, and **overflowing with thankful- ness.**" (Colossians 2:6-7)

30 DAYS OF PRAYING THROUGH YOUR NEIGHBORHOOD

Day Twelve: Today as I walk I will pay attention to the buildings, the businesses, non-profits, schools, and churches. What is already happening in my neighbor- hood and how may I join in and help these organizations? *Lord, please lead me as I consider how involved I should become in my neighborhood.*

Day Thirteen: Today I will pray at a park or playground. When was the last time I intentionally visited our community center? *Lord, I long to be a "known character", one that is recognized, loved, and respect- ed. Use me in this "place".*

Day Fourteen: Today I will pray for laborers to flow out of the neighborhood. "When He saw the crowds, He had compassion on them, because they were harassed and helpless, like sheep without a shepherd. Then He said to His disciples, 'The harvest is plentiful but the workers are few. Ask The Lord of the harvest, therefore, to send out work- ers into His harvest field.' " (Matthew 9:36-38)

Day Fifteen: *Lord, would You please deepen my love for my neighborhood, this "place" I call home.* "The Word became flesh and moved into the neighborhood." (John 1:14, The Message)

Day Sixteen: Today I will meditate on these four words: **Soften**, **Center**, **Listen**, and **Respond**. *Lord, may you keep my heart* **Soft** *and open,* **Centered** *in Christ,* **Listening** *to your Holy Spirit, and* **Responding** *in love.*

Day Seventeen: Today I will invite a friend to join me as I walk. (The relationship with this person will determine whether we pray together or simply walk while praying silently.) "For where two or three come together in My name, there I am with them." (Matthew 18:20)

Day Eighteen: "The entire law is summed up in a single command: 'Love your neighbor as yourself.' " (Galatians 5:14)

Day Nineteen: Who are the neighbors that God is moving and drawing me towards, nudging me to take that next step from "acquaintance" into "relationship"? *Lord, will You help me move towards friendship with my neighbors, going beyond simply knowing their names.*

Day Twenty: "You are the light of the world. A city on a hill cannot be hidden. Neither do people light a lamp and put it under a bowl. Instead they put it on its stand, and it gives light to everyone in the house. In the same way let your light shine before men, that they may see your good deeds and praise your Father in heaven." (Matthew 5:14-16)

Day Twenty-One: When was the last time we had a party at our house? Who could we invite? Who could help us? "Then Levi held a great banquet for Jesus at his house, and a large crowd of tax collectors and others were eating with them." (Luke 5:29)

Day Twenty-Two: *Lord, thank You for the gift of a new day! May You surprise me as I walk these streets and enjoy this time with You. May a "divine appointment" happen today!*

Day Twenty-Three: *Lord, would you please deepen my love for my neighbor- hood, this place I call home.* "The Word became flesh and moved into the neighborhood." (John 1:14, The Message)

Day Twenty-Four: Today as I walk I will ask God to give me a picture of what our neighborhood could become. *Lord, please increase the vision for my neighborhood.*

Day Twenty-Five: Today as I walk I will pray for insight on how I can "link" with other neighborhoods within my city.

Day Twenty-Six: "The number one obstacle to neighboring well is time. Do you currently live at a pace that allows you to be present in your neighborhood?" (*The Art of Neighboring*)

Day Twenty-Seven: "From one man He made every nation of men, that they should inhabit the whole earth; and He determined the times set for them and the exact places where they should live." (Acts 17:26-27)

Day Twenty-Eight: "Remember that God is and has been at work in your neighborhood. Part of leadership is attuning yourself to the breath of God as He brings new life to the dry bones of your place. Live in the freedom that comes from knowing that God loves your neighborhood far more than you ever will. You can actually trust God's love for your place." (*The New Parish*)

Day Twenty-Nine: *Lord, would You please deepen my love for my neighborhood, this "place" I call home.* "The Word became flesh and moved into the neighborhood." (John 1:14, The Message)

Day Thirty: "I'll be with you as you do this, day after day after day, right up to the end of the age." (Matthew 28:20)

THIS TOOL IS MEANT TO BE SHARED.
To download this resource, visit navlink.org/neighborhood

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SHARE GOD'S LOVE WITH YOUR NEIGHBORS

Jesus puts loving God and neighbor into perspective:

"Love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your mind. This is the first and greatest commandment. And the second is like it: Love your neighbor as yourself" (Matthew 22:37-39).

In John 1, we see that Jesus came to us in flesh and blood—God incarnate. Eugene Peterson in The Message paraphrase of the Bible expresses Jesus' coming this way:

The Word became flesh and blood, and moved into the neighborhood. (John 1:14)

God has placed you in your neighborhood for a reason, so consider how you can show God's love to your neighbors.

7 SIMPLE WAYS TO SHOW CHRIST'S LOVE TO YOUR NEIGHBORS:

• **Greet people.** Say hello as you walk along your block or work in your yard.

• **Go out front.** Be intentional about spending time in the more public parts of your yard or building. Rather than sitting on your back patio, put chairs in front of your house.

• **Go first.** Often people are just waiting for someone else to take the initiative. They may be open to connecting but just haven't gotten around to starting the connection. Go first by introducing yourself, sharing information, and asking questions.

• **Gather contact information.** Collect names, phone numbers, and email addresses for those on your block or the floor of your apartment building. Express how you want to help people be connected to each other in times of need. Ask people their permission to share the list on the block.

• **Give and receive.** Be the neighbor who offers to give help to others, whether it's loaning out a tool or a cup of sugar for a neighbor's baking project. Also be willing to receive. Ask for help when you need it, as that can break down barriers.

• **Get creative.** Consider what makes your neighborhood unique and how you can love and serve your neighbors. Your own actions in your neighborhood may be different from what works in another setting.

• **Go before God in prayer for your neighbors.** Pray specific prayers when you know neighbors well enough to know their situations. Observe and pray for those you don't know as well. For example, a house with toys scattered out front is home to a family — even if you don't know them, pray for God's grace on their family relationships.

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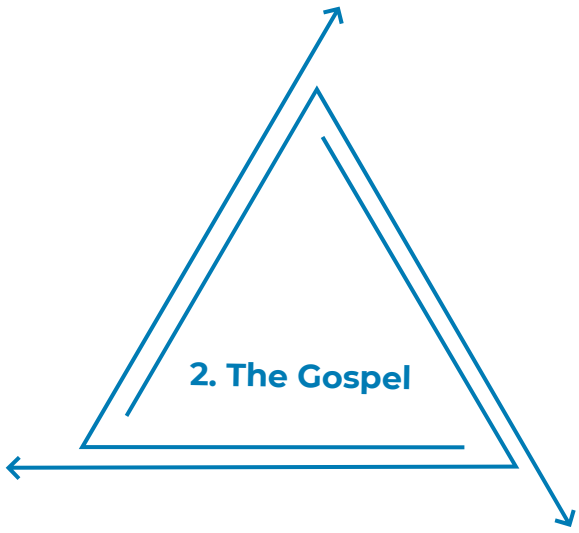
3D GOSPEL

To the weak I became weak, to win the weak. I have become all things to all people so that by all possible means I might save some.
1 Corinthians 9:22

The apostle Paul is emphatic that there is one Gospel. But this same Gospel is good news to all people everywhere! **Begin by watching the video linked below. Then read the different narratives provided. Consider how each narrative challenges or expands your view of the Gospel.**

1.Video:

Guilt - Innocence



Shame - Honor

Fear - Power

3. Application

- As a result of this study, how is the Gospel more applicable in your own life?
- How might you phrase the Gospel more applicably to those around you? Consider your family, friends, neighbors and coworkers.

Empower

God is...

30 DAYS OF PRAYING
the Names and Attributes of God

Though God is infinitely far above our ability to fully understand, through the Scriptures He tells us truths about Himself so that we can know Him, and be drawn to worship Him. Take a description of God and meditate on it for a day.

1 JEHOVAH
The name of the independent, self-complete being—"I AM WHO I AM"—only belongs to Jehovah God. Our proper response to Him is to fall down in fear and awe of the One who possesses all authority. *Exodus 3:13-15*

2 JEHOVAH-M'KADDESH
This name means "the God who sanctifies." A God separate from all that is evil requires that the people who follow Him be cleansed from all evil. *Leviticus 20:7,8*

3 INFINITE
God is beyond measurement—we cannot define Him by size or amount. He has no beginning, no end, and no limits. *Romans 11:33*

4 OMNIPOTENT
God is all-powerful. He spoke all things into being, and all things—every cell, every breath, every thought—are sustained by Him. Nothing is too difficult for Him. *Jeremiah 32:17,18, 26,27*

5 GOOD
God is the embodiment of perfect goodness, and is kind, benevolent, and full of good will toward all creation. *Psalm 119:65-72*

6 LOVE
God's love is so great that He gave His only Son to bring us into fellowship with Him. His love encompasses the world, and embraces each of us personally and intimately. *1 John 4:7-10*

7 JEHOVAH-JIREH
"The God who provides." Just as He provided yesterday, He will provide today and tomorrow. He grants deliverance from sin, the oil of joy for the ashes of sorrow, and eternal citizenship in His Kingdom for all those adopted into His household. *Genesis 22:9-14*

8 JEHOVAH-SHALOM
"The God of peace." We are meant to know the fullness of God's perfect peace, His "shalom." God's peace surpasses understanding and sustains us through difficult times. It's the product of fully being what we were created to be. *Judges 6:16-24*

9 IMMUTABLE
All that God is, He has always been. All that He has been and is, He will ever be. He is ever perfect and unchanging. *Psalm 102:25-28*

10 TRANSCENDENT
God is not simply the highest in an order of beings (this would be to grant Him eminence). He is transcendent—existing beyond and above the created universe. *Psalm 113:4,5*

11 JUST
God is righteous and holy, fair and equitable in all things. We can trust Him to always do what is right. *Psalm 75:1-7*

12 HOLY
God's holiness is not a better version of the best we know. God is utterly and supremely untainted. His holiness stands apart—unique and incomprehensible. *Revelation 4:8-11*

30 DAYS OF PRAYING
the Names and Attributes of God

13 JEHOVAH-ROPHE
"Jehovah heals." God alone provides the remedy for mankind's brokenness through His son, Jesus Christ. The Gospel is the physical, moral, and spiritual remedy for all people. *Exodus 15:22-26*

14 SELF-SUFFICIENT
All things are God's to give, and all that is given is given by Him. He can receive nothing that He has not already given us. *Acts 17:24-28*

15 OMNISCIENT
God is all-knowing. God's knowledge encompasses every possible thing that exists, has ever existed, or will ever exist. Nothing is a mystery to Him. *Psalm 139:1-6*

16 OMNIPRESENT
God is everywhere, in and around everything, close to everyone. "'Do not I fill heaven and earth?' declares the Lord." *Psalm 139:7-12*

17 MERCIFUL
God's merciful compassion is infinite and inexhaustible. Through Christ, He took the judgment that was rightfully ours and placed it on His own shoulders. He waits and works now for all people to turn to Him and to live under His justification. *Deuteronomy 4:29-31*

18 SOVEREIGN
God presides over every event, great or small, and He is in control of our lives. To be sovereign, He must be all-knowing and all-powerful, and by His sovereignty He rules His entire creation. *1 Chronicles 29:11-13*

19 JEHOVAH-NISSI
"God our banner." Under His banner we go from triumph to triumph and say, "Thanks be to God, who gives us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ" (1 Corinthians 15:57). *Exodus 17:8-15*

20 WISE
All God's acts are accomplished through His infinite wisdom. He always acts for our good, which is to conform us to Christ. Our good and His glory are inextricably bound together. *Proverbs 3:19,20*

21 FAITHFUL
Out of His faithfulness God honors His covenants and fulfills His promises. Our hope for the future rests upon God's faithfulness. *Psalm 89:1-8*

22 WRATHFUL
Unlike human anger, God's wrath is never capricious, self-indulgent, or irritable. It is the right and necessary reaction to objective moral evil. *Nahum 1:2-8*

23 FULL OF GRACE
Grace is God's good pleasure that moves Him to grant merit where it is undeserved and to forgive debt that cannot be repaid. *Ephesians 1:5-8*

24 OUR COMFORTER
Jesus called the Holy Spirit the "Comforter," and the apostle Paul writes that the Lord is "the God of ll comfort." *2 Corinthians 1:3,4*

25 EL-SHADDAI
"God Almighty," the God who is all-sufficient and all-bountiful, the source of all blessings. *Genesis 49:22-26*

26 FATHER
Jesus taught us to pray, "Our Father" (Matthew 6:9), and the Spirit of God taught us to cry, "Abba, Father," an intimate Aramaic term similar to "Daddy." The Creator of the universe cares for each one of us. *Romans 8:15-17*

27 THE CHURCH'S HEAD
God the Son, Jesus, is the head of the Church. As the head, the part of the body that sees, hears, thinks, and decides, He gives the orders that the rest of the body lives by. *Ephesians 1:22,23*

28 OUR INTERCESSOR
Knowing our temptations, God the Son intercedes for us. He opens the doors for us to boldly ask God the Father for mercy. Thus, God is both the initiation and conclusion of true prayer. *Hebrews 4:14-16*

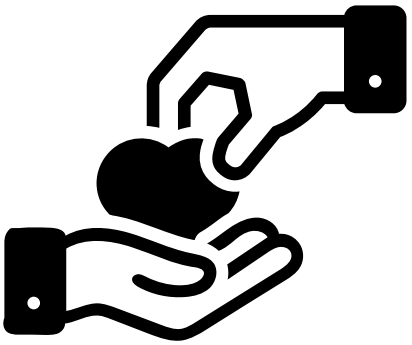
29 ADONAI
"Master" or "Lord." All God's people ought to acknowledge themselves as His servants, with His right to reign as Lord of our lives. *2 Samuel 7:18-20*

30 ELOHIM
"Strength" or "Power": He is transcendent, mighty and strong. This name displays His supreme power, sovereignty, and faithfulness in His covenant relationship with us. *Genesis 17:7,8*

THIS TOOL IS MEANT TO BE SHARED. To download a copy visit navlink.org/names-of-God

Sources: The Knowledge of the Holy, by A.W. Tozer; Names of God, by Nathan Stone; and God of Glory, by Kenneth Landon.

Empower



DOING GOOD

Jesus tells us in **Matthew 5:14-16**, *"You are the light of the world. A city set on a hill cannot be hidden. Nor do people light a lamp and put it under a basket, but on a stand, and it gives light to all in the house. In the same way, let your light shine before others, so that they may see your good works and give glory to your Father who is in heaven."*

Consider also Paul's words in **Ephesians 2:10,** *"For we are His workmanship, created in Christ Jesus for good works, which God prepared beforehand, that we should walk in them."*

Through doing good to our neighbor and fellow man we display the light of God to a dark and broken world. These good deeds not only give our Father glory, but are prepared beforehand by God for us to do! And while the merit of one's salvation is entirely based on the completed work of Christ's death and resurrection, we are instructed in James 2:14-26 to manifest our faith in Christ through our loving good deeds to those around us.

Spend time doing a Bible Study on the topic of "Doing Good" from the verses and instructions below.

- Psalms 34:14
- Psalms 37:3
- Psalms 37:27
- Ecclesiastes 3:12
- Isaiah 1:17
- Micah 6:8
- Matthew 5:16
- Matthew 7:12
- Matthew 12:12
- Mark 7:37
- Mark 12:30-31
- Luke 6:27
- Luke 6:33-35
- Acts 10:38
- Romans 2:7
- Romans 13:8
- Galatians 5:14
- Galatians 6:9-10
- Ephesians 2:10
- 2 Thessalonians 3:13
- 1 Timothy 6:18
- 2 Timothy 2:21
- 2 Timothy 3:17
- Titus 2:7
- Titus 2:14
- Titus 3:1
- Titus 3:8
- Titus 3:14
- Hebrews 10:24
- Hebrews 13:16
- James 2:8
- 1 Peter 2:12
- 1 Peter 3:8-11

1 Read the included passages seeking to understand the context they were written in.

2 Make observations about "doing good" from the passages included. Consider questions like "what," "who," "where," and "how."

3 Summarize your findings into two or three key statements.

4 Decide on one action you could take in order to apply what you learned from this study. Share that application with a friend.

Empower



THE GREAT TITHING MISUNDERSTANDING

“How much are Christians supposed to give?” A common answer is "10%! Because the 'tithe' is the Lord's! (Deut 14:22)"

So who owns the rest?

Unfortunately an unintended consequence of teaching 10% tithing (giving to a local church) is that many can walk away believing 10% is the Lord's and the rest is ours!

In 2019, Christians gave an average of only 2.5% of their income (during the height of the Great Depression the number was closer to 3.3%). For families making $75k+ income, only 1% give at least 10% in tithing. Americans spend the same amount on missions to the unreached 10-40 window as they do on Halloween costumes... for their pets! Certainly we have some re-learning to do as a culture.

Consider the following two examples and discuss how much you would advise each person to give:

1. A single dad is raising two children. He earns $800/mo, and pays $600 in rent and groceries. How much should the single dad tithe?
2. A wealthy doctor earns $250,000 a year. Tithing 10% leaves this woman with $225,000 a year to live on. How much would you encourage her to give?

Jesus makes mention of the Old Testament tithe in only two passages (Matthew 23:23-24 and Luke 18:9-14). Paul is equally silent on the topic of the 10% tithe. But both Jesus and Paul talk frequently about giving. Read and discuss the two passages listing guidelines from both Paul and Jesus on giving.

- 2 Corinthians 8:7, 9:6-7
- Luke 21:1-4

So how much should a person give? Perhaps a suggestion is to *give in such a way that it makes a difference in your lifestyle*. Biblically, where else might we give? New Testament examples include the poor (Galatians 2:10), orphans and widows (James 1:27), and missions (Philippians 4:10–20). Give where you choose. Paul summed it up in 2 Corinthians 9:7: “*Each man should give what he has decided in his heart to give.*”

Spend time answering the following questions to help form conclusions on this topic: What do you believe about tithing? What are you taught about giving? How do these conclusions influence other areas of your life where you are entrusted something of limited quantity (such as time, energy, etc.)?

Empower



SABBATH

The concept of a weekly day of rest can be very powerful in our lives when exercised in Biblical ways. This brief study merely introduces us to the principle of Sabbath and is meant to encourage us in our lives as we grow in grace, peace, and knowledge of Him.

What is a Sabbath? *"It is a small yet ample chunk of space, a narrow yet full segment of time. In it you can lie down and rest. From it you can rise up and go -- stronger, lighter, ready to work again with vigor and a clear mind. It is room enough, time enough, in which to relinquish all encumbrances, to act as though their existence has nothing whatsoever to do with your own. It is an invitation, at one and the same time, to empty yourself and fill yourself."* The Rest of God, Mark Buchanan.

Spend time studying and making observations from the passages below:

Genesis 2:2-3: *When and why did God introduce the idea of Sabbath?*

Exodus 16:21-30: *The Israelites were just delivered by God from 215 years of slavery. What are some Sabbath concepts in this passage?*

Exodus 19:1-6: *What was the major message God was communicating to Israel?*

Exodus 20:8-11: *Compare the length of the fourth commandment to the other ten. Why do you think that is?*

Exodus 31:12-17: *What important concepts about the Sabbath do you notice? What is God saying the Sabbath is meant to be to the rest of the world?*

Matthew 11:28-30: *What is the message Jesus gives to His disciples? How is this connected to the idea of Sabbath?*

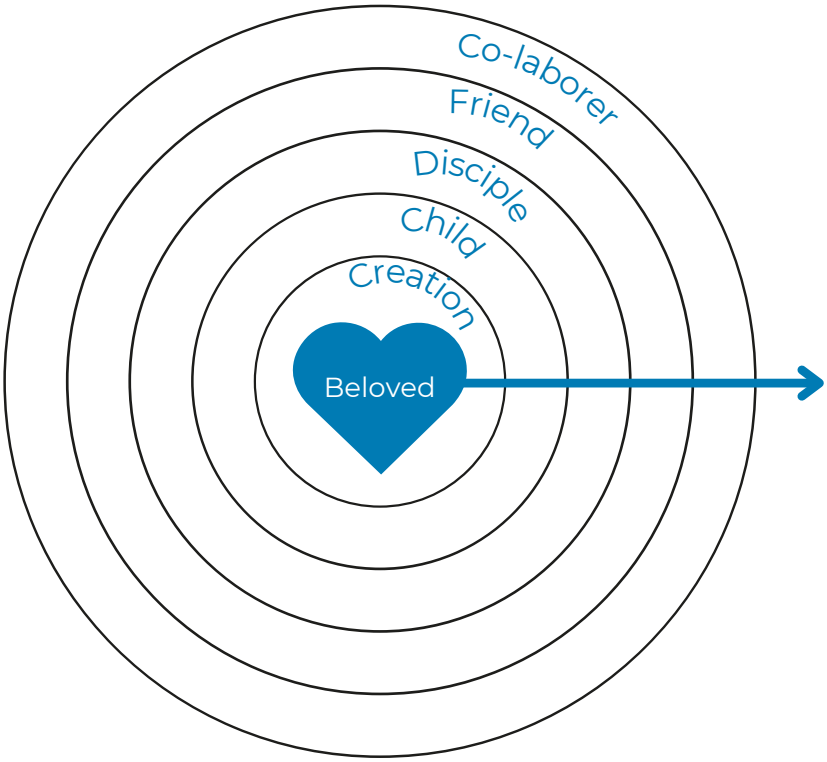
Matthew 12:1-14: *How might Jesus identifying himself as Lord of the Sabbath be significant? How had the Pharisees abused the concept of Sabbath? How is the Sabbath abused today?*

Reflection Questions

- Why do you think God commanded the Israelites to have a Sabbath?
- How is it to be practiced today? What are some practical advantages of a Sabbath?
- What new convictions has God given you? What does God want you to do/not do regarding the Sabbath? What will you apply to your life and ministry as a result of this study?
- What hindrances do you foresee?

Empower

IDENTITY:
BEING BEFORE DOING



There is no hierarchy of identities as followers of God. In fact, because we are in relationship with a trinitarian God, we have multiple relationships with God simultaneously. What is important is not the achievement of new "identity qualifiers" but rather the reality that we are beloved before we do anything for God.

***Beloved*:** Before anything we do and after everything we have done, we are deeply loved by God.
(Jeremiah 31:3, Zephaniah 3:17, John 3:16, Romans 5:8)

***Creation*:** Whether we choose to follow Jesus as our Lord and savior or we remain in rebellion, no one may escape the fact that they are a creation of the mighty and eternal creator God. And if a creation, then a bearer of His image.
(Genesis 1:27, Psalm 139:13-16, Isaiah 45:6)

***Child*:** The very first identifier God gives us as beloved creations is child. This is exclusive to those that put their faith in Jesus, who won on the cross the reconciliation of all people to God, and it requires no effort on our part to receive this title.
(John 1:12, Romans 8:15, 1 John 3:1)

***Disciple*:** As a child of God, he invites us to not only learn from Him but imitate Him and His life. To learn how to live like a son, we have to learn from the Son. As students of a mighty rabbi, we must seek to study His word and heed His instruction.
(Matthew 4:19, John 6:68-69, Galatians 2:20)

***Friend*:** As we follow our mighty creator, father, savior, and teacher, we grow in intimacy with Him as a friend. It is hard to live in friendship with a creator and father who you do not obey first.
(Exodus 33:11, Psalm 25:14, John 15:15)

***Co-laborer*:** Shared Goals are relational glue. It is apparent and significant that God does not need man's help, but desires the relationship of laboring together in the "family business" of making disciples. He chooses us to help accomplish His advancement of His kingdom here on earth.
(1 Corinthians 3:9, Ephesians 2:10, Colossians 1:28-29)

Empower

THE COMMON RULE

We are shaped by the company we keep and the habits we form. That is why it is vital to be intentional about determining our close friends and our cornerstone habits.

The author Justin Whitmel Earley wrote a book called The Common Rule, where he offered a helpful guide for loving God and our neighbors.

Consider the domains below:



LOVE OF GOD

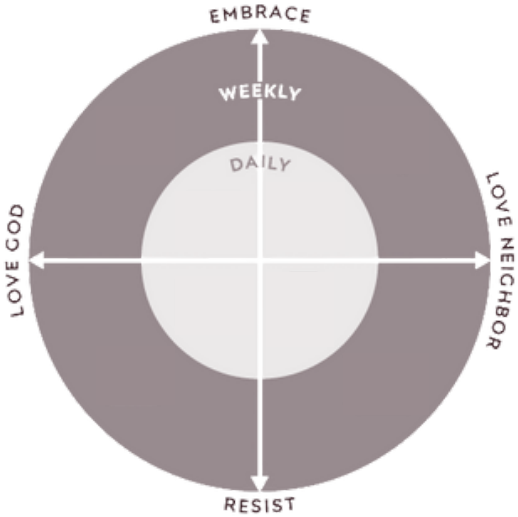
Another way to look at the habits is as they pertain to love of God. You were made to love and be loved by God. Only in light of this love will you see who you really are and discover what to do with your days.

LOVE OF NEIGHBOR

When we think of better habits, we often think about our own self-improvement. In the Common Rule, these habits are meant to be practices with others for their sake.

EMBRACE

Embrace is a reminder that there is much good in the world God made. We want to be intentional to take advantage of it through regular rhythms.



RESIST

When we practice resistance, we acknowledge that evil and suffering are very real, and not how the world was meant to be. The purpose of resistance is to love; not shield you from the world, but turn your compassion towards it.

Now spend time creating a Common Rule for yourself to more intentionally love God and others in this season. Share this with some friends and determine how you would like to hold each other accountable.

THIS TOOL IS MEANT TO BE SHARED. Adapted from The Common Rule by Justin Whitmel Earley.

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